

4 The future of gaming

While we discuss all the technologies that are already available, it is what lies ahead for the video gaming world that deserves more print space. Intel's former President Gordon Moore has made a famous prediction that has come to be known as Moore's Law, where he stated the number of transistors you could fit on a circuit of a certain size double every two years or so.

This leads to the current trend of faster processors and GPUs that we see coming out every year. As hardware progresses, its applications in the gaming industry obviously multiply manifold. With a field that is a mash-up of creativity and technological skill, it leads to new and different ways of using what one person has manufactured.

It is not possible to predict just what exactly the next generation of video game consoles will turn out to be. What we can put our finger on, though, are the trends that seem to be emerging...

4.1 Motion Sensing

The greatest example of what we mean by predicting trends but not predicting actual applications can be seen in the current example of motion sensing in video games. Given all the hype around us, it seems that the Nintendo, with the Wii, is the propagator and inventor of the idea of using physical motion as a means to control virtual environments via high-precision sensors.

If you think about it, though, you will realise that the base idea has been around since Sony's PlayStation came out with the first EyeToy. After all, the thought being both was the same – use a sensor (one used a camera while another used infrared LED lights) to detect the motion of the gamer and translate it to the virtual environment he sees on screen, and letting him manipulate it freely.

The best application of the technology, so far, has been the Nintendo Wii and so we remember the Wii as “truly” bringing motion sensors to gaming.

It can fairly be argued that this is the trend that will define the technology behind the current lot of video game consoles, especially since at this year's E3, Sony and Microsoft unveiled their own takes on motion-sensing gaming. Let's take a look at the PlayStation Motion Controller and Xbox Project Natal.

4.1.1 PlayStation Motion Controller

Nobody had predicted that the Nintendo Wii would be the winner of this latest competition among three video game giants, but the motion sensitive WiiMote won over the hearts of many, many millions. Sony wants in on the action and so has unveiled its own Motion Controller.

Shaped like a wand, the technology is dependant on the PlayStation Eye, much like the Wii depends on the Sensor Bar.